



Proud moment: Marissa, daughter of Mary D'Souza, receives the Lifetime Achievement award on her mother's behalf from Saket Lakkad senior vice-president (Finance), Casagrand and K. C. Vijaya Kumar, Sports Editor, The Hindu (middle).

R. V. MOORTHY

her trademark smile.

Her daughter Marissa accepted the Sportstar Aces Lifetime Achievement Award on her behalf in Mumbai and fondly recalled her mother's connection with the heritage venue, where she once worked as a Lakme girl selling perfume.

"Thank you to Sportstar and The Hindu Group for this recognition. Throughout her career, sports journalists have been her unwavering allies, especially when she faced obstacles like political interference, lack of funding, and nepotism. And now, in the twilight of her life, you have come through for her again — lifting her spirit with this award and reminding her that she is not forgotten," Marissa said.

In a recorded message, Mary said, "Although born in British-occupied India, representing free India remains one of the proudest moments of my life. Looking back at my sports career, life tested me with struggles and rewarded me with triumphs. It taught me that success isn't just about winning but about hard work, spirit and determination. To young athletes, believe in yourself, work hard and face every challenge with confidence. Success isn't measured just by medals but by the effort and dedication you put into your journey. Thank you, Sportstar, for this recognition. With all my health issues, I knew God was keeping me alive for a reason. I am so grateful to be recognised when I am alive."

Mary D'Souza Sequeira's achievements

- * One of India's first female Olympians, representing the country in the 1952 Helsinki Olympics.
- * Won gold, silver, and bronze medals at the 1951 Delhi Asian Games and 1954 Manila Asian Games.
- * Set national and Asian records in short sprints by 1956.
- * Represented India in both athletics and field hockey, becoming India's first female double international.
- * National champion — Dominated Indian athletics, setting multiple national records in sprint events.